

Analysis Vitiating by Two Types of Instability. The extent to which common-stock analysis has been vitiated by these two developments, (1) the instability of tangibles and (2) the dominant importance of intangibles, may be better realized by a contrast of specific common stocks prior to 1920 and in more recent times. Let us consider four typical examples: Pennsylvania Railroad; Atchison, Topeka, and Santa Fe Railway; National Biscuit; and American Can.

Pennsylvania Railroad Company

Year	Range for stock	Earned per share	Paid per share
1904	70-56	\$4.63	\$3.00
1905	74-66	4.98	3.00
1906	74-61	5.83	3.25
1907	71-52	5.32	3.50
1908	68-52	4.46	3.00
1909	76-63	4.37	3.00
1910	69-61	4.60	3.00
1911	65-59	4.14	3.00
1912	63-60	4.64	3.00
1913	62-53	4.20	3.00
1923	48-41	5.16	3.00
1924	50-42	3.82	3.00
1925	55-43	6.23	3.00
1926	57-49	6.77	3.125
1927	68-57	6.83	3.50
1928	77-62	7.34	3.50
1929	110-73	8.82	3.875
1930	87-53	5.28	4.00
1931	64-16	1.48	3.25
1932	23-7	1.03	0.50
1933	42-14	1.46	0.50
1934	38-20	1.43	1.00
1935	33-27	1.81	0.50
1936	45-28	2.94	2.00
1937	50-20	2.07	1.25
1938	25-14	0.84	0.50